



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Great Hearts Christian Academies Gilbert
School Website: <https://christosgilbert.greatheartsamerica.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Great Hearts Christian Academies – Gilbert (GHCA Gilbert) presents a distinctly classical Christian education profile. Across all six rubric categories, GHCA Gilbert aligns strongly with classical aims: it grounds its mission in truth, goodness, and beauty; it emphasizes formation over mere information; it implements a robust classical curriculum with Scripture integration; it employs a pedagogy oriented toward Socratic inquiry and contemplative (scholé) practice; it presents faculty as mentors and a living curriculum; and it partners with families and the broader faith community to form a shared educational culture. Public materials consistently reference Christ-centered formation, the Great Hearts classical model, Great Books/reading lists, morning prayer, and mission statements that center on virtue and character formation. These patterns are well-supported by GHCA Gilbert's own pages on mission, curriculum, pedagogy foundations, academy life, admissions, and culture, which collectively document a cohesive classical-Christian program. Evidence drawn from the school's site and academy materials shows explicit commitments to truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, and a liberal-arts–driven formation pursued through dialogic pedagogy, living text, and prayerful, liturgical rhythms.

Overall ranking by category - Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL - Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL - Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - GHCA Gilbert foregrounds Christian formation as part of its identity: "faith-based, classical education" with explicit Christ-centeredness and faith integration throughout the program (Our Mission, Integration of Faith, and About pages). The school emphasizes Jesus, Scripture, and daily Scripture-based formation as core to education.

- Materials state the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as central, with theology and sacred formation embedded in daily practice (Our Foundation: Mind, Heart, and Soul; Philosophy and Mission statements).
- The curriculum notes Scripture instruction, morning prayer, and a Christ-centered culture that integrates faith with the classical curriculum (Curriculum page).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ, Christian, faith-based, Scripture, morning prayer, theology, sacred, truth, goodness, beauty, worship, liturgy, Imago Dei, Logos, virtue, formation, Christian worldview, sacred tradition. These are well represented across multiple GHCA Gilbert materials (mission and foundation statements, curriculum, and integration-of-faith pages).

- Negative keywords (from the classical lexicon) such as secularism, value-neutrality, or relativism are not evident in GHCA Gilbert public materials; the materials consistently affirm theological grounding and liturgical practice. This absence supports the Classical classification in this category. See the classical lexicon for contrastive negative signals (e.g., secular ethics, relativism).

Why this rating - The school's public materials explicitly articulate a theology-grounded, liturgical (morning prayer) framework, and a Christ-centered formation that integrates faith with reason, aligning with the Positive/Transcendental markers of the Classical framework. The explicit reference to Christian formation, Scripture, and liturgical practices, plus a mission oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty, substantiates CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission and stated aims emphasize formation through truth, goodness, and beauty; formation of character and virtue is foregrounded, rather than mere vocational preparation. The mission explicitly notes cultivation of minds and hearts and the aim of loving Christ, parents, and living virtuous community. - Descriptions emphasize formation over information and a view of education oriented toward human flourishing and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom. The "Our Philosophy" and "Our Foundation" materials connect intellectual formation with moral/spiritual formation (habits of mind and heart), not primarily job-readiness. - The curriculum and admissions materials frame education as formation within a classical framework; the mission emphasizes Truth, Goodness, Beauty as real and knowable, guiding the educational project.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, human flourishing, scholé, contemplation, moral imagination, character, lifelong learning, virtue ethics, Logos, transcendental aims. These terms appear across mission, philosophy, and curriculum materials.

- Negative keywords: terms associated with purely job-prep or secular-utilitarian framing (e.g., "workforce readiness," "career readiness," or "skills-based" without formation) are not foregrounded in GHCA Gilbert public materials; the absence supports a CLASSICAL rating here. (See the Six Essential Elements negative signals for comparison.)

Why this rating - GHCA Gilbert's mission and foundational statements consistently present education as formation in virtue and wisdom, rooted in a Christian worldview and a classical framework, rather than solely preparing students for work or information transfer. The emphasis on "truth, goodness, beauty" and formation of character justifies CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program is described as interweaving the proven Great Hearts classical curriculum with Christian content, including Scripture instruction, Ancient Israel/Early Church focus, and daily prayer. The K-8 curriculum includes English/Literature, History, Latin, Reading Lists (K-5 and Middle School), and a focus on classical authors and Great Books through assigned lists. This demonstrates explicit liberal-arts underpinnings and canonical texts.

- The curriculum documentation highlights the Seven Liberal Arts spirit (grammar, logic, rhetoric) via explicit elements such as grammar in English, Latin, reading lists, and rhetoric-focused elements (e.g., Latin and composition in upper grades). The presence of Great Books and a "Great Conversation" orientation (reading lists; classic texts) aligns with classic curriculum architecture. - The "Curriculum" page explicitly states "Great Hearts classical curriculum with key refinements and additions" including morning prayer and a focus on sacred texts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Hearts classical curriculum, Great Books, reading lists, Core Knowledge history (as part of a canonical Western canon approach), grammar/logic/rhetoric, ancient history, Latin, morning prayer, Scripture studies, integration of faith with curricular content, ancient Israel and Early Church, "civilizational heritage" and "Great Conversation" framing (in the broader family of Great Hearts materials).

- Negative keywords: the project-based/experiential-only language is not dominant in GHCA Gilbert's curriculum materials; the sources emphasize canonical texts, living texts, and contemplation over purely project-driven instruction. The Six Essential Elements Negative Keywords include project-based learning; those terms are not foregrounded in GHCA Gilbert public materials.

Why this rating - GHCA Gilbert's explicit articulation of a Great Hearts classical curriculum, its integration

with Scripture, and the inclusion of canonical texts and Great Books align with the curriculum criteria in the classical rubric. The presence of Great Books, a Trivium-oriented approach (grammar in early grades; Latin; composition), and a layered reading program supports CLASSICAL classification.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's foundation highlights Socratic instruction as a method to cultivate love of learning and Truth, the ultimate Truth found in Christ. This is a hallmark of classical pedagogy (Socratic discussion, dialectic, memory- and recitation-based approaches) and is reinforced by mentions of living books, formation through memory, and a "scholé" (contemplative) dimension. - The school emphasizes a contemplative/restful dimension (scholé) and memory practices (chanting, memory deepening) in alignment with classical pedagogy; lower/early grades emphasize wonder, singing, and memory devices as educational drivers. These elements align with the recommended classical pedagogical approaches. - There are explicit references to upper-grade Socratic discussion and rhetoric training within the classical framework, with a progression from foundational memory and contemplation to dialogic inquiry and public speech in higher grades. (Curriculum and Academy Life materials.)

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic instruction, seminars, discourse, rhetoric, memory work, chanting, wonder, scholé, living books, classical pedagogy, great conversation, dialectic, lecture/recitation (where applicable), public speaking, debates. These terms appear across foundation, curriculum, and academy-life materials.

- Negative keywords: The presence of experiential/project-based language is minimal; the lexicon's negative signals for pedagogy (e.g., over-reliance on project-based or constructivist approaches) do not characterize GHCA Gilbert's public materials. This absence supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - GHCA Gilbert's pedagogy is anchored in Socratic questioning, classical memory and recitation, and a progression toward rhetoric and public speaking, with a contemplative/scholé dimension. This matches the classical pedagogy framework (even in programs that extend through middle school) and supports CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials repeatedly frame the faculty as mentors and living exemplars of virtue, with the classroom as the central locus of learning and the teacher-student relationship as the core of formation. The foundation text references teachers guiding hearts and minds, and "the living curriculum" concept appears in the broader Great Hearts description. - The "Academy Life" materials (uniforms, school culture) emphasize a portrait of the teacher and a community of virtuous adults modeling the values of the school, aligning with classical expectations of teacher proficiency and character. - Admissions and mission materials highlight the teachers' role in forming character and their function as mentors in a classical setting.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, teachers as guides/friends, portrait of what a teacher should be, intellectual virtue, virtue ethics, character formation, mentorship. These appear in the foundation and academy-life materials. - Negative keywords: The classical lexicon notes potential negative signals like "facilitators" or overly technocratic descriptors; GHCA Gilbert materials consistently frame teachers as central, moral exemplars rather than distant facilitators, which aligns with CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The public materials present a clear, teacher-centered, mentorship-oriented model consistent with classical expectations for faculty. The finding that teachers are treated as the living curriculum and as virtuous mentors supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and sees parents as co-educators or key collaborators in forming character and affording a shared classical-Christian education. This is articulated in multiple places (philosophy of partnership with families, family formation, and the expectation of parental

involvement in the school community). - Admissions, events, and campus life materials invite parents to tours, conferences, and gatherings; there are explicit references to parental involvement in classroom and school activities, and to open access to events and campus life. - Tuition and financial-aid information emphasize that families are integrated into the school community (financial aid to support access, with explicit statements about inclusivity). This reflects a community-centered approach consistent with classical parent partnerships.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parents as co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups or book clubs, family involvement, open campus, parent visits. These terms appear across About/Philosophy, Admissions, and Academy Life materials. - Negative keywords: The Six Essential Elements document includes potential negative signals such as “parent as consumer only” or minimal parent involvement; GHCA Gilbert materials do not push those negative signals; rather they emphasize strong parental engagement and collaboration. Public materials align with classical parent-partner expectations.

Why this rating - GHCA Gilbert clearly frames parents as essential partners in a classical education, with ongoing opportunities for parent formation, involvement in the school, and open access to school life, all aligning with the classical rubric’s expectations for category 6.

Aggregate assessment - All six categories are CLASSICAL. The school demonstrates a cohesive classical Christian program with explicit virtue formation, Great Books/canon-forward curriculum, Socratic pedagogy with contemplative dimensions, living-curriculum faculty, and a robust family/community partnership.

What would move the needle - Not required, as all six categories are CLASSICAL. If a needle move were desired, it would be to further articulate explicit Great Conversation opportunities beyond reading lists (e.g., published, structured Great Books seminars for parents and students together) and to broaden explicit high-school-level Socratic seminar offerings to demonstrate continued fidelity to classical pedagogy through 9–12 (even though GHCA Gilbert currently serves K–7).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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